Giuseppe Forte

Department of Economics, University College London, London, WC1H 0AX
giuseppe.forte.19@ucl.ac.uk – gfrt0.github.io –

RESEARCH AREAS

Industrial Organization, Applied Microeconomics, Structural Econometrics

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy, Economics — University College London, 2020 – 2027 (expected)
Visiting Student Researcher, Stanford University — 11/2023 – 05/2024
Enrichment Year, Institute for Fiscal Studies — 2022 – 2023
PhD Scholar, cemmap — 2022 –
Master of Research, Economics (Distinction) — University College London, 2019 – 2020
Master of Philosophy, Economics — University of Oxford, 2017 – 2019

REFERENCES

Áureo de Paula
University College London
a.paula@ucl.ac.uk

Lars Nesheim
University College London
l.nesheim@ucl.ac.uk

João Granja
University College London
joao.granja@ucl.ac.uk

JOB MARKET PAPER

In the Stars: Buyer and Seller Value of Online Ratings

Online ratings are a controversial determinant of consumer choices and firm fates. Their availability has unclear net and distributional welfare effects across buyers and heterogeneous sellers. I develop a model to quantify these effects, which I apply to data from the California residential photovoltaic market. I find that ratings raise consumer surplus by $65.8 million over 2016–2022, closing 76% of the gap to full information. Ratings redistribute sales and profits from low-quality firms to high-quality ones, and they raise total producer surplus. Ratings transfer surplus predominantly by redirecting sales, rather than by affecting prices. Most of the consumers' gain comes from which installers they ask for quotes, rather than from their choice among the quotes they receive.

WORKING PAPERS

Recursivity and the Estimation of Dynamic Games with Continuous Controls
(with João Granja, University College London)
Submitted

We study the estimation of dynamic games with continuous control variables, such as investments in R&D, quality, and capacity. We use the recursive characterization of Markov Perfect Equilibria (MPE) to develop estimators that exploit the structure of optimal policies. In particular, we derive a pseudo maximum likelihood estimator for models with shocks to firms' marginal costs of investment. We evaluate the performance of these estimators in two Monte Carlo exercises, including a version of the Hashmi and van Biesebroeck (2016) model of innovation in the automobile industry extended to allow for entry and exit. We find that estimators based on recursive equilibrium conditions perform well and outperform the inequality estimator of Bajari, Benkard, and Levin (2007).

Welfare Effects of the 2026 Italian Fuel-Excise Cut
Submitted

This article evaluates the welfare effects of the temporary excise cut on petrol and diesel introduced by the Italian government in March 2026 in response to the oil-price shock triggered by the closure of the Strait of Hormuz. I estimate pass-through from a difference-in-differences along the Italy–France border using daily station-level prices. I find 83% of the petrol cut and 74% of the diesel cut reached consumers at the pump. Plugging the pass-through estimates into a sufficient-statistics framework, I find a net welfare gain of EUR 107 million against a fiscal cost of EUR 841 million. Though the fiscal cost is broadly in line with a window-rescaled version of the official parliamentary scoring, imperfect pass-through routed a substantial share of the private welfare gain to refiners and retailers — 15% on petrol and 28% on diesel — at odds with the consumer-price-relief intent signalled by the decree's own anti-speculation provisions. The policy also delivered a relatively low marginal value of public funds of 1.13.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Semiparametric Estimation of Dynamic Continuous Choice Problems
(with João Granja, University College London)

PUBLISHED RESEARCH

The Impact of Migration on Productivity: Evidence from the United Kingdom
(with Francesco Campo, University of Padua, and Jonathan Portes, King's College London)
B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis & Policy, 24(2) (2024): 537–564

The Economic Impact of Brexit-Induced Reductions in Migration
(with Jonathan Portes, King's College London)
Oxford Review of Economic Policy, 33s1 (2017): S31–S44

AWARDS

George Webb Medley Prize for Best Thesis — University of Oxford, 2019

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Economics (1st year UG)	University College London, 2025 – present
Statistical Methods in Economics (1st year UG)	University College London, 2024 – 2025
Topics in Industrial Economics (3rd year UG)	University College London, 2021 – 2023
Empirical Industrial Organisation (MSc)	University College London, 2022 – 2023
Advanced Economics of Finance (3rd year UG)	University College London, 2022 – 2023

WORK EXPERIENCE

RA to Prof. Elena Pastorino	Stanford University, 08/2020 – 11/2023
RA to Prof. Jonathan Portes	King's College London, 09/2016 – 07/2017

FURTHER INFORMATION

Programming Languages: Julia, Python, R, Stata, Matlab; LaTeX.
Languages Spoken: English (Fluent); Italian (Native).
Citizenship: Italian.
ONS Accredited Researcher — 2017–2027